SPAGHETTI ALLA PUTTANESCA

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
South	**4-6**	**1 h 15 min plus the caper soak**

INGREDIENTS

75 g	Olive oil
50 g	Garlic, thinly sliced
62 g	Oil-packed anchovy fillets, very finely chopped
3 g	Dried red chile flakes
30 g	Tomato paste
1588 g	Whole San Marzano tomatoes, crushed by hand, from two 794 g cans
140 g	Pitted Taggiasca olives, cut into quarters
32 g	Small salt-packed capers, rinsed
quantity not given	Salt
624 g	Extruded spaghetti

METHOD

1. Set a heavy pot or Dutch oven over low heat. Put in the olive oil and the sliced garlic and cook them gently 10 to 15 seconds, until fragrant but with no color.
2. Stir the anchovies in and keep stirring about 30 seconds, until they start melting into the oil.
3. Add the chile flakes, then the tomato paste. Stir constantly for 30 to 45 seconds, until the oil turns reddish.
4. Tip in the tomatoes with their juice and stir them through. Raise the heat to medium-low and hold a slow simmer 30 to 45 minutes, until the raw edge of the tomato is gone and the flavors have knitted. You are not trying to reduce the sauce.
5. Off the heat, stir in the olives and capers. Salt carefully, because the olives, anchovies and capers already bring a great deal of salinity.
6. Measure out 540 g of sauce for this dish. The rest keeps 3 days in an airtight container in the fridge, or freeze it.
7. Salt a large pot of water generously and bring it to the boil.
8. Cook the spaghetti 5 to 8 minutes, to al dente.
9. While it boils, warm the measured sauce in a large saute pan over low heat.
10. Lift the pasta across with tongs or a pasta basket and raise the heat to medium. Toss 1 to 2 minutes to marry, adding a splash of pasta water if the sauce starts to tighten. It is married when it clings with a glossy sheen.
11. Divide into bowls.

NOTES

Soak the salt-packed capers in cold water for about 2 hours before you use them. Refresh the water about every 15 minutes until they taste briny rather than salty.
Go very easy on added salt. Three of the ingredients arrive heavily salted already.
The sauce simmers for 30 to 45 minutes only to cook the rawness out of the tomatoes. It is not reduced.
Olives and capers go in off the heat at the end so each stays distinct rather than being cooked into submission.
The sauce makes more than the 540 g the dish needs. Hold the surplus back.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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